# Start, Grow, Scale

Your Government Contracting Business

START — GROW — SCALE

Scan for free resources
govcongiants.org/jted-2026

# I talk to hundreds of small businesses every week.

8,000+ bootcamp registrations. 49K+ YouTube subscribers.

I see what works. I see what doesn't.

# Now Let's Talk Market

The State of Federal Contracting in 2026

# $834B

FY2025 Federal Contract Spending

# Largest. Ever.

# 28.8%

Went to Small Business = $183.5B

# But the headlines say...

*"1,100 Firms Suspended from 8(a) Program"*

*"SBA Data Call Targets Small Business"*

*"8(a) Program Under Investigation"*

# Scary, right?

# Here's what they're NOT telling you.

# $26B

8(a) Awards in 2025 — ALL-TIME RECORD

> *"1,100 firms suspended? That means LESS competition for compliant businesses. The 8(a) program just hit its highest awards EVER. This is the strongest moment in 8(a) history."*
>
> **— Sam Le, GovCon Intelligence (17 years SBA Policy)**

# The Real Story

**$26B**
8(a) Record Awards

**1,100**
Firms Removed

↓
Less Competition

Eric's Take

**Bad actors getting removed = MORE opportunity for compliant small businesses. Stay compliant. Stay ready.**

# What Changed

Revolutionary FAR Overhaul

Executive Order 14275 • April 2025 • First changes effective Feb 1, 2026

Biggest rewrite in 40+ years — faster acquisitions, plain language, more competition

# Rule of Two

is SAFE — FAR (Federal Acquisition Regulation) 19.104-1

COs MUST set aside if 2+ small businesses can compete.

# What Changed for Set-Asides

| Set-Aside Type | Before | After | Status |
|---|---|---|---|
| Small Business (Rule of Two) | MUST set aside | MUST set aside | SAFE |
| 8(a) Business Development | Emphasized | "MAY" set aside | CHANGED |
| HUBZone (Historically Underutilized Business Zone) | Emphasized | "MAY" set aside | CHANGED |
| SDVOSB (Service-Disabled Veteran-Owned SB) | Emphasized | "MAY" set aside | CHANGED |
| WOSB (Women-Owned Small Business) | Emphasized | "MAY" set aside | CHANGED |

"MAY" = Discretionary. Agencies CAN still use them — but you have to make the case.

# The Rule That Changed Everything

# 8(a) Follow-On Rule (FAR 19.108-11)

🔒

**"Once 8(a), Always 8(a)"**

Follow-ons locked to 8(a)

→

🔓

**8(a) follow-ons can move to HUBZone, SDVOSB, WOSB**

Doors opened

> *"If you're HUBZone or SDVOSB, doors just opened that were previously locked. Contracts that HAD to go to 8(a) can now come to you."*

# Thresholds Just Got Better

FAR Inflation Adjustment (Oct 2025) + NDAA FY2026 (Dec 2025)

**$15K**

Micro-Purchase

GPC (Gov't Purchase Card) buys
No competition required

FAR Case 2024-001 • Up from $10K

**$350K**

SAT

Simplified Acquisition Threshold
Faster awards, less paperwork

FAR Case 2024-001 • Up from $250K

**$35M**

CAS Exemption

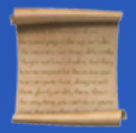
Cost Accounting Standards
No CAS-compliant system needed

NDAA FY2026 • Up from $2.5M

**What This Means For You**

**Under $15K = credit card buy. Under $350K = faster process. Under $35M = no expensive accounting systems.**

> *"I've talked to contractors who passed on bigger opportunities because they didn't want the CAS headache. That excuse is gone now. The ceiling just got a lot higher."*



# NDAA FY2026

National Defense Authorization Act

Signed December 18, 2025 • $895B Defense Budget

Most contractor-friendly NDAA in years — higher thresholds, less compliance burden

# TINA Threshold: $2M → $10M

Truth in Negotiations Act • Section 1804 • Effective June 30, 2026

## Before

$2M

Certified cost or pricing data required

- Full cost accounting disclosure
- Defective pricing liability
- DCAA audit risk

## After

$10M

Most A/E/C contracts now exempt

- Bid without certified cost data
- No defective pricing risk
- Lower compliance burden

**If you've avoided federal contracts because of cost accounting — this changes everything.**

# Progressive Design-Build Now Authorized

Section 2809 • First-ever congressional approval for MILCON

## Traditional Design-Build

- ✗ Lowest price wins
- ✗ Lock in price before design
- ✗ Change orders = adversarial

## Progressive Design-Build

- ✓ Selected on QUALIFICATIONS
- ✓ Collaborate during design
- ✓ Negotiate price AFTER scope is clear

Best for complex projects: shipyards, industrial facilities, overseas bases

# More NDAA Wins for A/E/C

Section 2814

## Multiyear Contracting

Construction contracts can now span multiple fiscal years

- Longer planning horizons
- Fewer stop-start procurements
- Better workforce continuity

Section 2816

## Cost-Plus for Shipyards

CPIF contracts authorized for SIOP projects

- Acknowledges complexity risk
- Dry dock modernization
- Waterfront recapitalization

**Section 2803:** DoD must now publish 20-year infrastructure improvement plans — visibility into the pipeline

# What DoD Is Desperate to Fix

Where the A/E/C Money Is Going

**$33B+**

Air Force Backlog

Aging bases need facility recapitalization

**$1.5B**

NAVFAC Shipyards

SIOP modernization through FY2027

**$500M+**

Energy Resilience

Microgrids, solar, battery storage (ERCIP funding)

✓ Climate resilience projects

✓ PDI Indo-Pacific construction

✓ Base hardening

# Where the A/E/C Money Is

Construction & Engineering Opportunities

# FY2025 → FY2026 Budget Trends

## Winners

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| DoD | $848B → $962B | **+$113B** |
| DHS | $65B → $107B | **+$42B** |
| VA | $160B → $187B | **+$27B** |

## Losers

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| State Dept | $59B → $10B | **-84%** |
| HHS | $127B → $94B | **-26%** |
| NASA | $25B → $19B | **-24%** |

Eric's Take

**If you're doing work for State or HHS, it's time to pivot. The money is moving to defense, veterans, and homeland security.**

# $10.4B

U.S. Army Corps of Engineers FY2026

# USACE (Army Corps of Engineers) — Where the Money Is

| Program | Budget | Opportunity |
|---|---|---|
| Civil Works | **$7.6B** | Flood control, coastal storm damage |
| Infrastructure (Waterways) | **$2.5B** | Construction, dredging |
| Harbor Maintenance | **$1.8B** | Port infrastructure |
| Ecosystem Restoration | $1.2B | Environmental engineering |
| Navigation Channels | $1.1B | Dredging, marine construction |
| Disaster Recovery | $900M | Rapid-response construction |
| Dam Safety | $800M | Structural engineering |

# USACE Pain Points = Your Opportunity

🏗️ Dam Safety Backlog

📊 Digital PM BIM/GIS

⚙️ Design-Build Mandates

📋 Permitting Bottlenecks

Eric's Take

**USACE is desperate for contractors who understand digital delivery. Show up with BIM capability and you're ahead of 80%.**

# USACE FY2025-2026 Priorities

$7.6B Civil Works + $2.5B Bipartisan Infrastructure Law

**$2.5B**

Inland Waterways

Lock & dam modernization
Dredging contracts

**$800M**

Dam Safety

Structural engineering
RFPs in Q3 FY2025

**$1.2B**

Ecosystem Restoration

Environmental engineering
Everglades, Great Lakes

$600M Levee Upgrades

$500M MILCON Support

$400M Climate Resilience

# USACE Jacksonville District

**$4B+**

Annual Construction

- 🌴 Everglades Restoration
- 🌀 Hurricane Recovery
- 🏗️ MILCON (Military Construction)

# $8.5B+

Naval Facilities Engineering Command

# NAVFAC (Naval Facilities Engineering) — Where the Money Is

| Program | Budget | What's Hot |
|---|---|---|
| MILCON (Military Construction) Indo-Pacific | **$2.3B** | Design-build at Pacific bases |
| Shipyard Modernization (SIOP) | **$1.5B** | Dry dock, facility upgrades |
| Infrastructure Resilience | $1.1B | Climate adaptation, coastal |
| MACCs (Multiple Award Construction Contracts) | **$950M** | Facility sustainment, repair |
| BRAC (Base Realignment & Closure) Cleanup | $800M | Environmental remediation |
| FSC (Facility Support Contract) Recompetes | $600M | Base operations, maintenance |
| ESPC (Energy Savings Performance Contracts) | $500M | Solar, microgrids |

> *"NAVFAC is one of the most small-business-friendly commands in DoD. Their MACC program is designed for you."*

**$950M**

in MACC Task Orders Open for Bidding

If you're not on a MACC, you're missing out.

# VA Construction

PACT Act Surge

# VA — PACT Act Infrastructure

**$2.7B**
PACT Act Infrastructure

**$50B+**
Deferred Maintenance Backlog

🏥 Toxic Exposure Clinics

📋 PM & Oversight Needed

⏰ 1,300+ Healthcare Sites

Eric's Take

**VA construction has been a mess. They're actively looking for contractors who can help them fix their project management.**

# Other A/E/C Opportunities

**$33B+**

Air Force Infrastructure Backlog

$800M at Tinker, Hill, Robins

**$7B**

Coast Guard Shore

$650M annual upgrades

**$20B+**

FEMA Disaster Relief

Climate construction surge

# The real game is

# Task Orders

# 55%

of federal dollars flow through vehicles — NOT the open market

> *"If you're only searching SAM.gov for 'open' solicitations, you're missing 55% of the opportunity."*

# A/E/C Vehicle Numbers (NAICS 236220)

**$400M**

USACE Savannah
SB Design-Build MATOC

**$249M**

NAVFAC Washington
8(a) MACC

**$700M+**

NAVFAC Active
Small Business MACCs

# Small Business MATOCs (Multiple Award Task Order Contracts) (NAICS 236220)

| Vehicle | Agency | Set-Aside | Ceiling | Task Order Size |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Savannah DB MATOC** | USACE Savannah | **100% SB** | $400M | $5M - $25M |
| **Sacramento MATOC** | USACE Sacramento | **100% SB** | $99M | $500K - $10M |
| **Omaha SDVOSB MATOC** | USACE Omaha | **SDVOSB** | $99M | $1M - $15M |
| **New England SB MATOC** | USACE New England | **100% SB** | $90M | $500K - $8M |
| **NAVFAC SE 8(a) MACC** | NAVFAC Southeast | **8(a)** | $107M | $1M - $20M |
| **NAVFAC Marianas 8(a)** | NAVFAC Marianas | **8(a)** | $75M | $500K - $10M |

Eric's Take

**These are $1M-$30M company targets. Stop chasing $1B IDIQs — get on these vehicles and build past performance.**

# Engineering IDIQs Expiring 2026 (NAICS 541330)

| Contract # | Agency | Incumbent | Value | Expires |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| DEEE0008029 | DOE Golden Field | CEG Solutions | $55B | Apr 2026 |
| DEEE0008034 | DOE Golden Field | Energy Systems Group | $55B | Apr 2026 |
| HQ072716D0001 | Defense Microelectronics | Lockheed Martin | $17.5B | Mar 2026 |
| 70B04C19D00000046 | DHS IT Contracting | CACI Federal | $3B | May 2026 |

New Vehicle Coming

**Air Force RAES — $3.4B A/E MATOC. 5 small business slots. Awards Aug 2026.**

# Heavy/Civil Construction Expiring 2026 (NAICS 237xxx)

| Contract # | Agency | Incumbent | Value | Expires |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| N6247325D5203 | NAVFAC Southwest | A&R Pacific-Garney JV | $249M | Dec 2026 |
| W912DQ21D1001 | USACE Kansas City | Dubuque Barge & Fleet | $99.5M | Sep 2026 |
| W912HY24D0003 | USACE Galveston | Great Lakes Dredge | $98M | Dec 2026 |
| W912EP21A0008 | USACE Jacksonville | Gale Construction | $25M | Jun 2026 |

**USACE Galveston $7B MATOC**

**Forgen-Ahtna JV won small business slot. Horizontal construction, dredging, flood control.**

# Partner with primes

# NOW

They're building teams for these recompetes TODAY.

# How to Win

What I see working every single day

# Don't Sleep on SAT Opportunities

# Why SAT (Simplified Acquisition Threshold) Wins

Contracts under $350K use streamlined procedures — faster awards, less paperwork, fewer competitors

**$350K**
Max Value
As of Oct 2025

**3+**
Vendors Solicited
vs full & open RFP

**21-45**
Days to Award
vs 90-180 for large contracts

**Eric's Take**

**Win 10 SAT contracts and you have the past performance to compete for the big ones.**

# Top SAT Agencies (NAICS 236220)

USASpending data: Construction contracts $10K-$350K (2024-2025)

| # | Agency | Why They Matter | SAT Volume |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | GSA (General Services Administration) | Federal building repairs, tenant improvements | $142M |
| 2 | VA (Veterans Affairs) | Hospital renovations, clinic buildouts | $103M |
| 3 | DOI (Dept of Interior) | National parks, BLM facilities, tribal projects | $57M |
| 4 | HHS (Health & Human Services) | CDC, NIH, IHS facility maintenance | $53M |
| 5 | USDA (Agriculture) | Forest Service, rural development projects | $36M |

Eric's Take

**Civilian agencies award MORE SAT construction than DoD sub-agencies. Don't sleep on GSA, VA, and Interior.**

> *"The contractor who shapes the requirement wins the contract. Don't be passive — go in EARLY. By the time the RFP drops, you should already know what's in it."*

# The Teaming Imperative

**70%**

MACC Task Orders Use Subs

Primes need YOUR specialty

## How to Approach Construction Primes

- Know their MACC/MATOC vehicles
- 1-page capability brief (bonding, certs)
- Offer a specialty they don't have
- FOLLOW UP after task order drops

# Two Companies.

# Same Contract.

# Different Outcome.

## Company A

Won small testing IDIQ. ~$50K.

- ✕ PM saw it as small job
- ✕ Sent tech to check boxes
- ✕ Zero relationships built
- ✕ No intel fed to BD

**$50K**

Contract ended. No follow-on.

VS

## Company B

Same type of contract.

- ✓ Saw it as a door
- ✓ Trained field person on BD
- ✓ Built COR relationships
- ✓ Fed intel back real-time

**$4M+ over 4 years**

Sole-source follow-ons.

> *"Most small businesses keep BD separate from operations. That's a mistake. Your best lead generators are the people doing the work."*

# The Business Case for BD Training

## Roles You Could Build

| | |
|---|---|
| BD Manager | **$85K–$130K** |
| Capture Manager | **$95K–$145K** |
| Market Research Analyst | **$80K–$135K** |

These are skills you can develop in your existing team.

## Why Upskill vs Hire?

- ✓ Your ops people know the customer
- ✓ They understand your delivery
- ✓ Retention beats recruitment
- ✓ Cross-functional teams win more

# Visibility

If They Can't Find You, They Can't Buy From You

LinkedIn • Website • Being Where Primes Are Looking

# What Agencies Are Saying

Real quotes from contracting officers and SBLOs

> *"Our biggest problem isn't finding contracts. It's finding qualified small businesses who can actually do the work."*

"We struggle to locate qualified small businesses"

"Small businesses aren't where we can find them"

"We don't know where to look"

**The Truth**

**You don't have a qualification problem. You have a visibility problem. And that's fixable.**

# LinkedIn vs SEO

## Speed Wins

## SEO (12-Month Grind)

✕ 100+ published content pieces
✕ 30+ top-3 Google rankings
✕ Pray algorithm doesn't change

12-Month Goal
**75K visitors**
(if everything works)

VS

## LinkedIn (Fast Lane)

✓ Results start with first post
✓ Algorithm favors consistency
✓ COs and primes scrolling

My LinkedIn Last Week
**110K impressions**
in 7 days

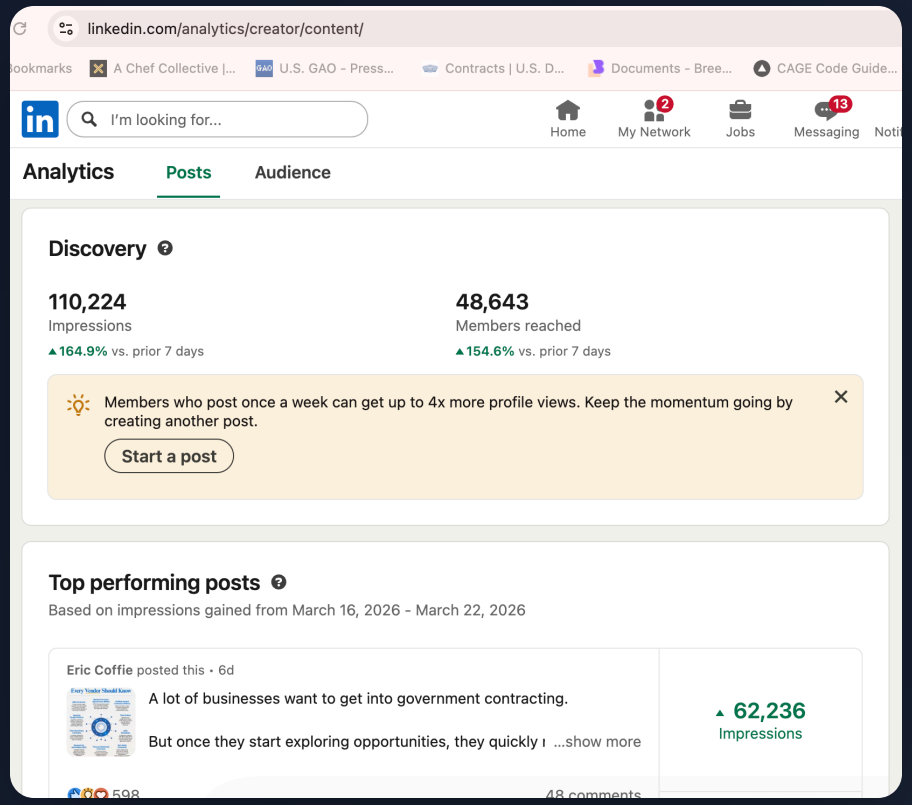
# 110K

LinkedIn impressions in 7 days

# This Is What Consistency Looks Like



My LinkedIn analytics — last 7 days




**110K impressions in 7 days. LinkedIn rewards consistency — not history.**

# LinkedIn Strategy That Works

🏆

**Share Your Wins**

Every award, every milestone

💬

**Comment on Agency Posts**

COs are watching

📢

**Publish Thought Leadership**

Pain points you solve

🤝

**Engage with Primes**

They're looking for subs

**Eric's Take**

**I've seen small businesses get on Sources Sought lists because a CO saw their LinkedIn post. Being invisible and hoping contracts find you doesn't work — COs Google you before they call.**

> *"The contractors winning right now are visible. They're not hiding behind their capability statements."*

# The Facts

**+$113B**
DoD Budget Growth

**$35M**
CAS Threshold

**$26B**
8(a) Record

✓
Rule of Two Safe

# Early Engagement is Everything

**Monitor Forecasts**
SAM, GovWin, agencies

**Request 1-on-1s**
Before RFP drops

**Respond to Sources Sought**
Even if you won't bid

**Build SBLO Relationships**
They're your advocates

# Set Up SAM.gov Alerts (Free)

🔔

**Your NAICS Codes**

Get notified on new opps

📍

**Your State/Region**

Local opportunities first

🏢

**Target Agencies**

USACE, NAVFAC, VA

📝

**Sources Sought**

Shape requirements early

**Eric's Take**

**90% of small businesses don't have SAM alerts set up. That's free intel delivered to your inbox every day.**

# Track Recompetes (12-18 Months Out)

📊

**USASpending.gov**

See contract end dates

🎯

**Identify Incumbents**

Research their performance

🤝

**Build Relationships**

Before the RFP drops

Eric's Take

**The best contracts are won 12-18 months before the solicitation. If you're waiting for SAM.gov, you're already late.**

# The question isn't whether the opportunity exists.

It's whether you're going to
**go get it.**

# AI

Artificial Intelligence for Market Intelligence

# AI Is Driving Construction Demand

Data centers need builders — federal agencies are paying attention

**$88B**
in data center projects starting in next 6 months

**190%**
year-over-year increase in construction spending

**76**
major projects breaking ground in 2026

WHERE THE MONEY IS GOING

**Virginia $15B • Louisiana $15B • Mississippi $14B • Texas $13B**

# How do I stay ahead of thousands of opportunities?

**85+**

Federal Procurement Portals

# Beyond SAM.gov

eBuy • DIBBS • SeaPort • FedConnect • PIEE • Agency Sites...

Are you checking them all?

# How Do You Track 250 Agencies and Thousands of Opportunities?

The data is scattered. Priorities shift. Budgets move.

You can't manually keep up.

# So I Built a Federal Intelligence Database

Aggregating data from 10+ federal sources, updated continuously

**250**
Federal Agencies & Sub-Agencies

**2,765**
Agency Pain Points Documented

**2,500**
Strategic Priorities with Budget Data

**2,768**
Prime Contractors Mapped

TOTAL INTELLIGENCE

**5,265+ actionable insights with fiscal year budgets (FY2024-2027)**

# Where Does This Data Come From?

**NDAA**
National Defense Authorization Act

**GAO**
Gov't Accountability Office

**OMB**
Office of Mgmt & Budget

**Executive Orders**
102 Active Orders

**NIST/CISA**
Cybersecurity Standards

**USASpending**
Contract Awards

**SAM.gov**
Live Opportunities

**Agency OIGs**
55 Inspector Reports

**CBO**
Budget Forecasts

**Federal Register**
Regulatory Changes

CONTINUOUS UPDATES

**AI scans these sources daily and updates agency intelligence automatically**

# What This Delivers To Me

Every Day. Automatically.

# What AI Delivers Every Week

### Daily Opportunity Alerts

SAM.gov opportunities matching MY NAICS codes, delivered before competitors see them.

4x daily

### Daily Briefings

Curated intel with win probability scores, agency insights, and teaming opportunities.

Every morning 6 AM

### Weekly Deep Dive

Full competitive analysis of 10 opportunities including bid history and win strategies.

Every Sunday

### Weekly Pursuit Brief

AI picks MY best opportunity and gives me a detailed pursuit plan with win probability.

Every Monday

# Key Takeaways

🚀

# START

- ✓ Get visible (SAM.gov, LinkedIn)
- ✓ Get certified (8(a), SDVOSB, HUBZone)
- ✓ Fix your capability statement

📈

# GROW

- ✓ Win SAT contracts ($350K)
- ✓ Sub to primes (build past perf)
- ✓ Use AI to free up time

🏆

# SCALE

- ✓ Get on contract vehicles
- ✓ Chase task orders (55% of spend)
- ✓ Team strategically for recompetes

# Your Action Items

This Week

1. Review your certifications — 8(a) to HUBZone flexibility is real
2. Start CMMC assessment — Don't wait for the RFP
3. Get on contract vehicles — MACCs, SeaPort, MATOC

4 Engage early — Tomorrow's win starts with today's relationship

5 Use AI — Free up time for business development

6 Be visible — LinkedIn, industry events, agency outreach

# Low Hanging Fruit

## What Most People Miss

# The bar has never been so low.

# 5 Things

## That Set You Apart

# 1

## Do what you say you're going to do.

# 2

# Show up on time.

# 3

# Deliver excellence.

# 4

## Communicate often and thoroughly.

In person. In writing.

# 5

## Be known as a person who gets things done.

# Before you leave today:

# Meet 3 Primes

for teaming opportunities.

# Download the Guide

All the data from today's presentation

**govcongiants.org/jted-2026**

📊 10 Expiring Contracts

🤝 Teaming Plays

📝 Templates & Prompts

Eric Coffie | GovCon Giants | @govconeric

🙏

# Thank You

Now go meet 3 primes before you leave.

| YouTube | LinkedIn | Website |
| --- | --- | --- |
| **@govcongiants** | **Eric Coffie** | **govcongiants.org** |